

All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

Building Up: A Blueprint for the Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Act

Part Three — The Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Act: A Constructive Blueprint

Section 3.3 — The Substantive-Standards Areas: The Seven Non-Education Operational Domains

Section 3.2 identified the eight substantive-standards areas the *Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Act* establishes. Section 3.3 develops the substantive content of seven of those areas: built environment and outdoor public spaces, information and communications, employment, transportation, design and delivery of services and programs, health, and goods and procurement. The eighth area, education, is developed in Section 3.4 because the substantive content is more extensive than the seven non-education areas and because it operationalizes Article 24 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* directly in response to the engineered repudiation documented in Sections 1.3a and 2.7a.

The seven areas Section 3.3 develops are mutually reinforcing rather than mutually exclusive. Many specific accessibility issues operate across multiple areas simultaneously. A healthcare facility's accessibility, for example, is partially a built-environment question (physical access to the building), partially an information-and-communications question (accessible patient communications), partially an employment question (accommodation of healthcare workers with disabilities), and partially a design-of-services question (the accessibility of the appointment, diagnostic, and treatment processes). The substantive-standards-development process must accordingly address the operational interfaces between areas as well as the substantive content within each area.

Each of the seven areas follows a consistent substantive structure. The substantive scope identifies what the standards in the area regulate. The substantive content identifies the specific elements the standards must address. The technical specifications identify the established technical standards (where applicable) the standards should reference. The coordination provisions identify the existing Alberta regulatory frameworks with which the new standards must coordinate. The Convention alignment identifies the relevant articles of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* the standards operationalize. The documented Alberta record identifies the substantive Alberta evidence on which the substantive content is grounded.

The detailed implementation timelines for each area are developed in Section 3.7. Section 3.3 specifies the substantive content; Section 3.7 specifies the operational schedule on which the content is delivered.

Area 1: Built Environment and Outdoor Public Spaces

The substantive scope of Area 1 is the accessibility of buildings, outdoor public spaces, infrastructure, and equipment within these settings, regulated under provincial jurisdiction. The area extends beyond the existing *Alberta Building Code* coverage in three substantive directions: from new construction and major renovation to include retrofit of existing buildings on a structured timeline; from buildings to include outdoor

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public spaces, parks, playgrounds, recreational facilities, and public infrastructure that the Building Code does not cover; and from physical structures to include the equipment within those structures.

The substantive content of the Area 1 standard must address: accessibility requirements for new construction and major renovation that exceed the existing *Alberta Building Code* in the elements where the Code is currently insufficient (operational guidance includes door-width specifications calibrated to power-mobility devices, accessible-route specifications addressing the full range of mobility-device users, accessible-washroom specifications addressing assistance-required users, and accessible-egress specifications addressing the operational reality that emergency evacuation procedures frequently fail for persons with disabilities); structured retrofit requirements for existing buildings, prioritizing public-sector buildings (provincial-government facilities, school-division facilities, healthcare facilities, post-secondary facilities, library facilities, recreational facilities) on the most demanding timeline and private-sector buildings on tiered timelines calibrated to building type, size, and use; outdoor-public-space accessibility requirements covering trails, parks, playgrounds, public squares, beaches and waterfront access, public-event spaces, and public infrastructure; equipment-accessibility requirements covering playground equipment, recreational equipment, public-use equipment, and equipment within healthcare and educational settings; wayfinding accessibility covering tactile and visual signage, audible announcements, and orientation infrastructure; and emergency-egress accessibility covering accessible evacuation routes, accessible refuge areas, and accessible communication during emergencies.

The technical specifications the Area 1 standard should reference include the Canadian Standards Association *CSA B651 series* (Accessible Design for the Built Environment), the *Rick Hansen Foundation Accessibility Certification* (RHFAC) standards as a benchmarking reference, and the international design standards developed by the International Code Council and the International Organization for Standardization. The substantive standards should be expressed in terms that survive technical evolution, with reference to the latest applicable versions rather than to specific versions that will become outdated.

The coordination provisions must address the relationship between the Area 1 standard and the existing *Alberta Building Code*, the *Alberta Fire Code*, the *Highway Traffic Act* and related infrastructure legislation, and the *Municipal Government Act*. The *Alberta Building Code* addresses building accessibility at the time of construction or major renovation; the Area 1 standard supplements the Code by addressing existing buildings on a retrofit timeline and by addressing outdoor public spaces and equipment that fall outside the Code's substantive scope. The coordination must ensure that the two regulatory frameworks operate consistently and that organizations subject to both frameworks have a clear understanding of the integrated obligations.

The Convention alignment is Article 9 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities*, which establishes the obligation on State Parties to take appropriate measures to ensure to persons with disabilities access, on an equal basis with others, to the physical environment, to transportation, to information and communications, and to other facilities and services open or provided to the public. Article 9's substantive content is operationalized across multiple areas of the legislation; Area 1 operationalizes the physical-environment dimension.

The documented Alberta record on which Area 1 substantive content is grounded includes the campaign's separate access-barrier documentation, the documented operational failures of existing-building

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accessibility across the provincial public sector, and the substantial accessibility gaps in outdoor public spaces and recreational facilities that the disability community has documented across multiple Alberta municipalities. The area's substantive content responds to the documented record at the operational level.

Area 2: Information and Communications

The substantive scope of Area 2 is the accessibility of information, communications, and digital technology, regulated across the public, private, and non-profit sectors within provincial jurisdiction. The area covers digital accessibility (websites, mobile applications, electronic documents, online services), document accessibility (printed and electronic documents), communications accessibility (oral, visual, and electronic communications), and technology accessibility (the compatibility of technology with assistive devices used by persons with disabilities).

The substantive content of the Area 2 standard must address: digital-accessibility standards establishing the *Web Content Accessibility Guidelines version 2.1 Level AA* as the substantive minimum for organizations subject to the legislation, with structured advancement to Level AAA where operationally feasible and to subsequent versions of the Guidelines (currently 2.2, with 3.0 in development) as they are adopted as international standards; document-accessibility standards covering alternative-format provision (Braille, large print, audio, electronic accessible formats, plain language, easy-read formats), the structured availability of alternative formats on request, and the proactive availability of alternative formats for documents of broad public significance; communications-accessibility standards covering sign-language interpretation provision (American Sign Language and *Langue des signes québécoise* as appropriate to the context, recognizing the linguistic-minority status of these communities), augmentative and alternative communication accommodation, captioning of audiovisual content, audio description of visual content, and the structured provision of communication support in public-facing interactions; and technology-accessibility standards covering compatibility with assistive technology, accessible-design requirements for procurement of technology by provincial-public-sector organizations, and the accessibility of digital interfaces used by persons with disabilities to access government services and programs.

The technical specifications the Area 2 standard should reference include the *Web Content Accessibility Guidelines* (current and subsequent versions), the *Authoring Tool Accessibility Guidelines* (ATAG 2.0), the *Web Accessibility Initiative Accessible Rich Internet Applications* (WAI-ARIA) specifications, the *EPUB Accessibility* specification for electronic publications, the *PDF/UA* specification for accessible PDF documents, and analogous international standards as they are developed and adopted.

The coordination provisions must address the relationship between the Area 2 standard and the federal *Accessible Canada Act* (which regulates federally regulated organizations including federally regulated digital services), the federal *Treasury Board Standard on Web Accessibility*, the *Saskatchewan Web Accessibility Policy* as a provincial comparator, and the existing Alberta provincial-government web standards. The coordination must ensure that organizations operating across federal and provincial jurisdictions have clear and consistent obligations and that the Alberta standards operate at or above the federal standards.

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The Convention alignment is Article 21 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (freedom of expression and opinion, and access to information), supplemented by Article 9 (accessibility) in the digital and technological dimension. Article 21 establishes the obligation on State Parties to take all appropriate measures to ensure that persons with disabilities can exercise the right to freedom of expression and opinion, including the freedom to seek, receive, and impart information and ideas on an equal basis with others.

The documented Alberta record on which Area 2 substantive content is grounded includes the accessibility gaps in Government of Alberta digital services (documented operationally in the campaign's information-asymmetry analysis), the structural inaccessibility of AISH and ADAP application processes to populations with cognitive, learning, and literacy-related disabilities, the documented absence of accessible alternative formats for many provincial-government documents, and the inconsistent provision of sign-language interpretation in public-facing provincial services.

Area 3: Employment

The substantive scope of Area 3 is the accessibility of employment relationships, including recruitment, hiring, accommodation, retention, advancement, return-to-work, and termination. The area applies to employers of all sizes within provincial jurisdiction (federally regulated employers fall under the federal *Accessible Canada Act* and are excluded), with tiered substantive obligations calibrated to organizational size and capacity per the coverage architecture established in Section 3.2.

The substantive content of the Area 3 standard must address: accessible recruitment processes covering the accessibility of job-posting communications, the accommodation of accessibility needs in application processes (including alternative-format applications, extended application timelines for applicants requiring accommodation, and accessible interview accommodations), and the elimination of recruitment practices that disproportionately exclude persons with disabilities; accessible hiring processes covering the accommodation of testing and assessment procedures, the bias-reduction infrastructure for hiring decisions, and the accommodation of disability-related needs in onboarding; structured workplace-accommodation processes covering the standardized procedure for requesting accommodation, the substantive presumption in favour of providing accommodation, the structured documentation of accommodation discussions and decisions, and the prohibition on the overuse of *undue hardship* defences to defeat accommodation requests; equal-access provisions covering training, professional development, mentorship, and promotion opportunities; structured return-to-work programs for employees returning after disability-related leave, including accommodation discussions before return, modified-duty arrangements, structured re-integration timelines, and the prohibition on adverse employment consequences for employees who exercise return-to-work rights; disability-aware performance-management frameworks that distinguish between performance issues attributable to inadequate accommodation and performance issues attributable to other factors; and accessible workplace-policy documents and accessible disciplinary processes.

The Area 3 standard must also address the structural employment-architecture issues that the documented Alberta record demonstrates have produced systemic employment exclusion for persons with disabilities. The structural issues include the inadequate AISH employment-earnings exemption (which

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structurally penalizes employment income above modest thresholds), the inadequate PDD employment-related supports (which fail to provide the wraparound supports that would enable persons with developmental disabilities to maintain employment), and the inadequate provincial-government infrastructure for supported employment, customized employment, and work-integration social-enterprise frameworks. The Area 3 standard cannot directly resolve the structural issues (which require coordination with the categorical-program architecture per Section 3.8), but the standard must require that provincial-public-sector employers and large private-sector employers operate employment practices that recognize the structural reality and operate in ways that do not compound the existing structural exclusion.

The coordination provisions must address the relationship between the Area 3 standard and the *Alberta Human Rights Act* (which addresses employment discrimination on protected grounds including physical disability and mental disability), the *Alberta Labour Relations Code* (which addresses unionized employment relationships), the *Workers' Compensation Act* (which addresses workplace-injury and return-to-work in the workers'-compensation context), the *Employment Standards Code* (which establishes minimum employment-standards), and the *Occupational Health and Safety Act* (which addresses workplace safety including for workers with disabilities). The coordination must ensure that the Area 3 standard supplements rather than displaces the existing legislative framework and that employers subject to multiple frameworks have clear and consistent obligations.

The Convention alignment is Article 27 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (work and employment), which establishes the right of persons with disabilities to work, on an equal basis with others, in work environments that are open, inclusive, and accessible to persons with disabilities.

The documented Alberta record on which Area 3 substantive content is grounded includes the campaign's separate systemic-exclusion documentation, the substantial Alberta evidence on the inadequacy of AISH employment-earnings exemptions, the documented inadequacy of PDD employment supports, the documented absence of provincial-government supported-employment infrastructure at the scale operationally required, and the disability-community advocacy on the structural-employment dimension across multiple lifecycle stages.

Area 4: Transportation

The substantive scope of Area 4 is the accessibility of transportation services, transportation infrastructure, and transportation-related communications, regulated within provincial jurisdiction. The area covers public transit (operated by municipal transit authorities), paratransit (specialized transportation for persons whose disabilities prevent the use of conventional public transit), intercity transit operating within provincial jurisdiction, taxi and rideshare services, transportation infrastructure (stations, terminals, bus stops, transit shelters), and transportation-related communications (route information, schedule information, real-time service information, booking systems). Federally regulated transportation (interprovincial rail, federally regulated air, federally regulated ferry services) falls under the federal *Accessible Canada Act* and is excluded from provincial coverage but addressed through coordination provisions in Section 3.8.

All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

The substantive content of the Area 4 standard must address: public-transit accessibility requirements covering accessible vehicles (accessible buses with low-floor or ramp-equipped designs, accessible light-rail and light-metro vehicles, accessible commuter-rail vehicles), accessible stations and stops (accessible boarding platforms, accessible station infrastructure, accessible signage and wayfinding, accessible information displays), accessible communications (accessible route and schedule information, accessible real-time service information, accessible booking and trip-planning systems), and accessible service provision (driver and operator training in disability-affirming practice, accommodation of service animals, accommodation of mobility devices); paratransit standards covering structured eligibility frameworks (calibrated to provide service to all persons whose disabilities prevent the use of conventional transit, not only to persons meeting narrow medical-model criteria), service-level standards (advance-booking timelines, on-time performance benchmarks, trip-completion benchmarks), service-area coverage (calibrated to ensure paratransit availability throughout the conventional-transit service area), and the prohibition on paratransit denial that effectively excludes persons with disabilities from community participation; intercity-transit accessibility requirements covering accessible vehicles, accessible boarding facilities, and accessible communications for intercity bus and rail services operating within provincial jurisdiction; taxi and rideshare accessibility requirements covering the structural availability of accessible taxi vehicles in fleet composition (mandatory minimum percentages of wheelchair-accessible vehicles), the accommodation provisions for rideshare services (accessible booking, accommodation of service animals, accommodation of mobility devices), and the regulatory framework that ensures rideshare-driver accountability for accessibility provisions; transportation-infrastructure accessibility requirements covering bus stops, transit shelters, station infrastructure, and the connecting pedestrian infrastructure that enables persons with disabilities to access transit services; and transportation-related communication accessibility per Area 2 substantive content as it applies in transportation contexts.

The coordination provisions must address the relationship between the Area 4 standard and the federal *Accessible Canada Act* and the *Accessible Transportation for Persons with Disabilities Regulations* under the federal *Canada Transportation Act* (which regulate federally regulated transportation), the *Highway Traffic Act* and analogous provincial transportation legislation, the *Municipal Government Act* (under which municipal transit authorities operate), and the operational practices of major Alberta municipal transit authorities (Edmonton Transit Service, Calgary Transit, Lethbridge Transit, Red Deer Transit, and others). The coordination must respect the operational autonomy of municipal transit authorities while establishing the substantive accessibility standards that all transit services must meet.

The Convention alignment is Article 20 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (personal mobility), which establishes the obligation on State Parties to take effective measures to ensure personal mobility with the greatest possible independence for persons with disabilities, supplemented by Article 9 (accessibility) in the transportation dimension.

The documented Alberta record on which Area 4 substantive content is grounded includes the documented service gaps in Edmonton Transit Service paratransit (DATS), the documented service gaps in Calgary Transit Access, the substantial absence of intercity rural transportation that disproportionately excludes rural persons with disabilities from community participation, the inadequacy of accessible-taxi fleet composition in major Alberta municipalities, and the disability-community advocacy on transportation-accessibility issues across multiple Alberta municipal contexts.

All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

Area 5: Design and Delivery of Services and Programs

The substantive scope of Area 5 is the accessibility of services and programs across public-sector, private-sector, and non-profit-sector organizations, including customer-service practices, service-design practices, program-design practices, and service-delivery practices. The area is the broadest of the seven non-education areas in operational scope, applying to virtually every organization that provides services to the public within provincial jurisdiction.

The substantive content of the Area 5 standard must address: customer-service standards covering the accommodation of accessibility needs in customer-facing interactions, the training of customer-facing staff in disability-affirming practice, the structured provision of communication support (including sign-language interpretation, written-communication alternatives, plain-language alternatives, and AAC accommodation) on request and in defined circumstances proactively, the accommodation of service animals, and the accommodation of support persons; service-design standards covering the application of universal-design principles in service design (designing services from the outset to be accessible to the full range of users rather than designing services for typical users and adding accommodations after the fact), the structured engagement of persons with disabilities in service-design processes, and the substantive accessibility evaluation of services prior to deployment; program-design standards covering analogous principles for program design (eligibility criteria designed to be accessible to the full range of intended beneficiaries, application processes designed to be accessible, program-delivery practices designed to be accessible, and the structured engagement of persons with disabilities in program design); service-delivery practices covering ongoing accommodation in service relationships, the structured handling of accommodation requests, the resolution of accommodation disputes, and the integration of accessibility considerations into ongoing service-quality improvement; application-process accessibility covering the substantive accessibility of application processes for benefits, programs, services, licences, and other government and non-government processes (this is the substantive content most directly relevant to the Access Gap analysis the campaign maintains as a parallel workstream); and complaint-and-feedback accessibility covering accessible complaint mechanisms, accessible feedback processes, and the substantive consideration of complaint-and-feedback information in ongoing service improvement.

The Area 5 standard is operationally significant because it addresses the substantive ground on which most operational disability-policy failures occur. The categorical-program architecture's documented operational failures (the AISH application inaccessibility, the PDD assessment-and-application inaccessibility, the FSCD application inaccessibility, the documented Access Gap across CRA, AISH, PDD, FSCD, and analogous government programs) are all substantively addressed within the Area 5 substantive scope. The standard cannot directly redesign the categorical programs (the categorical programs operate under their own enabling legislation), but the standard requires that the design and delivery of services and programs by all organizations subject to the legislation, including the public-sector organizations administering the categorical programs, comply with substantive accessibility standards.

The coordination provisions must address the relationship between the Area 5 standard and the enabling legislation of provincial-government programs (the *AISH Act* and analogous statutes), the *Alberta Human Rights Act* in its services-provision dimension, the *Consumer Protection Act* and analogous private-sector services legislation, and the analogous federal frameworks governing federal services and programs

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The Convention alignment is Article 9 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (accessibility) in its services-and-programs dimension, supplemented by Article 19 (living independently and being included in the community) where the services and programs in question are community-based services supporting independent living.

The documented Alberta record on which Area 5 substantive content is grounded includes the campaign's separate Access Gap documentation, the documented operational failures of categorical-program application processes, the substantial Alberta evidence on the inaccessibility of provincial-government services to populations with cognitive, learning, mental-health, and literacy-related disabilities, and the disability-community advocacy on services-and-programs accessibility across multiple lifecycle stages.

Area 6: Health

The substantive scope of Area 6 is the accessibility of healthcare facilities, healthcare services, healthcare communications, and healthcare-decision-making, regulated across the provincially-regulated healthcare system within provincial jurisdiction.

The substantive content of the Area 6 standard must address: healthcare-facility accessibility covering physical accessibility of hospitals, clinics, healthcare offices, long-term-care facilities, and analogous facilities (operationalizing Area 1 substantive content in the healthcare-facility context), accessible medical equipment (height-adjustable examination tables, accessible weight scales, accessible diagnostic equipment, accessible treatment equipment), and accessible patient-flow infrastructure (accessible registration, accessible waiting areas, accessible specimen collection, accessible imaging services); healthcare-services accessibility covering accommodation in clinical interactions, accessible appointment-booking processes, accessible diagnostic procedures, accessible treatment procedures, accessible discharge processes, and the structured accommodation of disability-related needs throughout the patient journey; healthcare-communications accessibility covering accessible health-information materials (operationalizing Area 2 substantive content in the healthcare-communications context), accessible informed-consent processes (including alternative-format consent forms, plain-language consent discussions, and the accommodation of supported-decision-makers in consent processes), accessible prescription-and-medication communications, and accessible care-planning communications; healthcare-decision-making accessibility covering the structured recognition of supported-decision-making frameworks in healthcare contexts (operationalizing Article 12 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities*), the prohibition on substitute-decision-making practices that exclude the patient from decision-making in their own healthcare, the structured recognition of advance-care-planning documents, and the structured accommodation of patients with cognitive disabilities, communication disabilities, and mental-health disabilities in decision-making processes; healthcare-worker training covering disability-affirming-practice training, anti-ableist-practice training, supported-decision-making training, and accommodation-provision training, integrated into the training and continuing-education frameworks of the relevant healthcare-worker regulatory bodies (the College of Physicians and Surgeons of Alberta, the College of Registered Nurses of Alberta, the College of Pharmacists of Alberta, and analogous bodies); mental-health-services accessibility covering the

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structural accommodation of mental-health-disability needs in mental-health-service delivery, the prohibition on mental-health-service practices that compound rather than ameliorate mental-health disability (including but not limited to involuntary-confinement practices in mental-health settings, where the practices exceed the substantive standards the international human rights framework establishes), and the integration of disability-rights frameworks into mental-health-system design; and end-of-life-and-palliative-care accessibility covering the structural availability of palliative care to persons with disabilities (a substantively distinct issue from medical-assistance-in-dying availability, which raises complex Convention-alignment questions and is not addressed in Area 6 substantive content), the structured accommodation of disability-related needs in end-of-life care, and the structured recognition of supported decision-making in end-of-life decisions.

The Area 6 standard does not address the structural-funding dimension of the Alberta healthcare system (Alberta Health Services budget allocation, healthcare-worker shortage, and analogous structural-funding issues operate under separate provincial-government policy frameworks). The standard addresses the substantive-accessibility dimension within the healthcare-system architecture as it operates. The structural-funding dimension is addressed through the analogous-substantive-equality argumentation that Section 1.3a applies to the K-12 system: where the structural-funding inadequacy of the healthcare system produces accessibility outcomes that disproportionately affect persons with disabilities, the legislation operates against the resulting barriers under the systemic-and-structural-barrier category established in Section 3.2's barrier definition.

The coordination provisions must address the relationship between the Area 6 standard and the *Hospitals Act*, the *Health Professions Act* (under which the healthcare-worker regulatory bodies operate), the *Alberta Health Care Insurance Act*, the *Mental Health Act*, the *Personal Directives Act*, and analogous healthcare-related provincial statutes. The coordination must respect the substantive authority of healthcare-worker regulatory bodies in their own substantive domains while establishing the substantive accessibility standards the bodies are required to incorporate.

The Convention alignment is Article 25 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (health), which establishes the right of persons with disabilities to the enjoyment of the highest attainable standard of health without discrimination on the basis of disability, supplemented by Article 12 (equal recognition before the law) in the supported-decision-making dimension, Article 19 (living independently and being included in the community) in the community-based-healthcare-services dimension, and Article 9 (accessibility) in the healthcare-facility-and-communications dimension.

The documented Alberta record on which Area 6 substantive content is grounded includes the campaign's separate healthcare-worker-shortage analysis, the documented AISH health-benefits erosion, the documented Alberta-healthcare-system access barriers across multiple disability populations, the substantial disability-community advocacy on healthcare-access issues, and the documented intersection of healthcare-access barriers with other lifecycle dimensions documented in Part One.

Area 7: Goods and Procurement

All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

The substantive scope of Area 7 is the accessibility of consumer goods (where the goods are designed for use by persons with disabilities or where their accessibility affects persons with disabilities) and the accessibility-related requirements for public-sector procurement of goods and services. Area 7 is operationally significant because it addresses two distinct accessibility-leverage points: the design of goods themselves, and the use of public-sector procurement to drive private-sector accessibility behaviour.

The substantive content of the Area 7 standard must address, in the consumer-goods dimension: design standards for goods specifically designed for persons with disabilities (medical devices, mobility devices, communication devices, assistive technology, accessible household goods), establishing substantive design requirements that ensure these goods are usable by the persons they are designed to serve and that the goods do not impose unreasonable barriers to use; design-consideration standards for goods that, while not specifically designed for persons with disabilities, have substantial accessibility implications (consumer electronics, household appliances, vehicles, transportation-related products), establishing structural-consultation requirements with persons with disabilities in the design and testing of these goods; and labelling-and-information standards covering the accessible communication of product information, including ingredient information, usage information, and safety information, in formats accessible to persons with disabilities (the labelling standards must coordinate with federal labelling requirements under the *Food and Drugs Act*, the *Consumer Packaging and Labelling Act*, and analogous federal legislation, recognizing that food and drug labelling is primarily federal jurisdiction).

The substantive content of the Area 7 standard must address, in the procurement dimension: provincial-public-sector procurement standards establishing accessibility-compliance requirements for goods and services purchased by provincial-public-sector organizations, including built-environment construction and renovation contracts, technology and digital-services contracts, transportation-services contracts, professional-services contracts, and consumer-goods contracts; supplier-qualification requirements covering the substantive accessibility-compliance qualifications suppliers must demonstrate to participate in provincial-public-sector procurement processes; contract-language requirements establishing the substantive accessibility provisions that must be included in provincial-public-sector contracts; and supply-chain accountability provisions establishing the responsibilities of prime contractors for the accessibility compliance of their subcontractors and suppliers.

The procurement dimension is a substantive-leverage strategy that the comparator legislation has used in varying forms. Provincial-public-sector procurement is a substantial portion of total economic activity in Alberta; procurement-specification requirements that mandate accessibility compliance produce private-sector accessibility behaviour at the supplier level even where the suppliers are not directly regulated by the legislation's other substantive standards. The leverage-strategy dimension is operationally significant for small-and-medium private-sector enterprises that may fall below the substantive-standards-coverage threshold but that participate in provincial-public-sector supply chains.

The coordination provisions must address the relationship between the Area 7 standard and the *Alberta Public Procurement Act*, the *Alberta Treasury Board Procurement Directives*, the *Public Sector Body and Procurement* provisions in the *New West Partnership Trade Agreement* and the *Canadian Free Trade Agreement* (which establish open-procurement requirements that must be respected in the substantive-accessibility-procurement-requirements design), and the federal procurement frameworks

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The Convention alignment is Article 9 of the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (accessibility) in its goods-and-services dimension, supplemented by Article 4 (general state-party obligations) in the structural-implementation dimension.

The documented Alberta record on which Area 7 substantive content is grounded includes the limited Alberta operational use of procurement-leverage strategy in disability policy, the comparator-jurisdiction record of procurement-leverage strategy effectiveness, and the disability-community advocacy on consumer-goods accessibility.

What Section 3.3 Establishes

The substantive content of seven of the eight substantive-standards areas of the *Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Act* is now specified at the depth required for legislative-drafting input. The seven areas address: built environment and outdoor public spaces (operationalizing Article 9 in the physical-environment dimension); information and communications (operationalizing Article 21 and Article 9 in the digital-and-information dimension); employment (operationalizing Article 27); transportation (operationalizing Article 20 and Article 9 in the transportation dimension); design and delivery of services and programs (operationalizing Article 9 broadly across services-and-programs); health (operationalizing Article 25, Article 12, Article 19, and Article 9 in the healthcare dimension); and goods and procurement (operationalizing Article 9 in the goods-and-procurement dimension).

The substantive content of each area is grounded in the documented Alberta record (drawn from Part One and the campaign's broader documentary record) and aligned with the international human rights framework Canada has bound itself to under the United Nations *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* (Part Two Section 2.7). The substantive specifications are detailed enough to guide legislative drafting and to provide the operational basis for subsequent standards-development processes, while preserving the technical-drafting and standards-specification work that legislative counsel and standards-development bodies will conduct.

The seven areas operate together as a comprehensive accessibility-standards framework. They are not exhaustive of every accessibility issue persons with disabilities encounter (no comparator framework is exhaustive), but they cover the substantive ground on which the documented Alberta-disability-community advocacy has identified the most operationally significant accessibility barriers. The eighth area, education, receives standalone development in Section 3.4 because the substantive content is more extensive than the seven areas Section 3.3 has addressed and because the engineered repudiation documented in Sections 1.3a and 2.7a requires a more detailed substantive response than the Section 3.3 summary structure can deliver.

The next section turns to the education-area standard.